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Plytix Content Guidelines 2026

Owner: Jessie Schnaible

Applies to: Everyone publishing customer-facing or public content.

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1. Foundations

These rules apply to every word written at Plytix, regardless of the department.

Role of the Plytix brand

Plytix is the platform brand. It's the voice that shows up everywhere: on the website, in-product, in help content, and in all external conversations with customers, prospects, and partners. Our job is to make product content feel **simpler, clearer, and more controllable**.

Role of the Plytix products

The Plytix products are how people experience the Plytix platform day to day. Each product delivers a specific outcome in the product content workflow and helps customers move from "messy inputs" to "publish-ready content," faster.

Together, our products create one connected product content management experience. They should feel consistent in naming, tone, and guidance, and they should make it easy for customers to understand what to do next and where to do it in Plytix.

2. Voice & tone

Voice vs Tone

Voice is our consistent personality. It never changes. It is the “who” behind the words.

Tone is the emotional setting of the moment. It adapts to the situation. Whether we are celebrating a win or helping with a technical error, the voice is the same, but the tone shifts to match the user's needs.

We sound like an experienced, friendly colleague (think Paul Rudd in a SaaS context): competent, relatable, and self-aware. We explain complex things without making the audience feel small.

Plytix Voice

Casual

Plytix is casual and approachable. We speak in a way that you could with your friends. No need to throw in fancy words just to impress someone (that rarely works anyway). This helps our audience feel comfortable and at ease. We're human too, and we want our audience to know that.

Respectful

Respect is another important value for Plytix. We always communicate respectfully in a way that is inclusive and kind to everyone. We consider others' feelings and viewpoints because we care about people and want to facilitate positive and productive conversations.

Authentic

Plytix is real and authentic. We always try to be as honest and transparent as possible. This is not only an important value that Plytix has, but it also helps build trust and a deeper connection with our audience.

Witty

Part of what makes Plytix special is our sense of humor. We keep things light-hearted and always throw in a dash of humor whenever we can. We aren't goofy or extreme, and we definitely don't force jokes if the comedic timing isn't there.

But we do like to entertain and engage our audience. This helps us build a stronger connection and keeps our audience wanting more.

The Voice Sidebar (Our North Star)

The Voice Check	Example
The Relatable Expert	"It's not magic, it's just better organization. Here's how you can set it up in five minutes."
The Subtle Wink	"This feature won't do your laundry, but it will keep your product data from flying in five directions."
What to Avoid (The Hype)	"Synergize your enterprise with our revolutionary, next-gen paradigm shift that transforms everything!"

Voice Traits and examples

Voice trait	Guidelines	What to write ✓ (Examples)	What not to write ✗ (Examples)
Casual	Clear, plain language without jargon. Inviting, not condescending. Speak to "you" when possible.	"PIM software helps you easily organize and manage your product information, so you can keep all your product details accurate and up-to-date in one place."	"Utilizing state-of-the-art PIM software solutions, enterprises can synergistically streamline the aggregation, synchronization, and dissemination of product-related data across multifaceted platforms..."

Respectful	Use inclusive and appropriate language. Avoid swear words. Never punch down at competitors (including spreadsheets). Educate instead of telling people what to do.	"Plytix PIM helps you maintain accurate product data, allowing you to focus on how you can grow your business even more."	"You need to get Plytix - it actually helps you get sh*t done, unlike f**cking boring spreadsheets and pathetic PIM tools."
Authentic	Be honest and transparent. Avoid misleading language. Show humility. Use concrete proof over vague promises.	"While PIM software won't fix every challenge, it can save significant time. Plytix helped save Leigh Country 99 hours per month in manual updates."	"PIM software will revolutionize your business overnight, providing 100% error-free data management and making all your processes completely effortless."
Witty	Add witty comments (and emojis when appropriate). Avoid forcing jokes. If it doesn't flow, leave it out. Use humor that is subtle and dry, not goofy or silly. One "wink" per page max.	"Think of PIM software as the hero of your product data. Always there, always reliable, but no cape."	"PIM software is like a superhero with a cape, swooping in to save the day! Whooooosh! ⚡🚀"

3. How we talk about Plytix and Plytix products

Consistency builds trust. Naming things the same way, every time, creates a shared language. It makes the platform feel reliable and easier to navigate.

Rules and examples

Rule	Why it matters	Examples
Call the platform "Plytix."	"Plytix" is the clearest anchor for readers.	 "In Plytix , you can..."  "In the system , you can..."
Avoid "the PIM" or "the system" in customer-facing content.	Those terms are vague and can confuse newer readers.	 "In Plytix PIM , you can publish updates across channels."  "In the PIM , you can publish updates..."
Use official product names exactly as written.	Keeps naming consistent and reduces "are these different things?" moments.	 Plytix PIM, Plytix DAM, Plytix Feed Management...  Abbreviations, misspellings, inconsistent capitalization
Spell out product names. Don't abbreviate.	Abbreviations create ambiguity, especially for new or non-native readers.	 "Plytix Feed Management"  "PFM" / "Feed tool"

Bridge customer terminology to ours. Don't correct them bluntly.	Feels helpful, not pedantic. Keeps momentum.	 "You may know this as an export feed. In Plytix, it's a channel."  "That's not called an output, it's a channel."
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Official product naming (copy-paste)

- Plytix PIM
- Plytix DAM
- Plytix Feed Management
- Plytix Brand Portals
- Plytix Product Data Sheets
- Plytix Shopify Content Manager
- Plytix AI

4. Rules of Engagement

Rule	Why it matters	Examples
Value first. No friction.	Make the helpful info easy to find, easy to skim, and ungated. Anticipate follow-up questions and answer them without detours.	 Put the "recipe" at the top. Make the how-to easy to reach.  Bury the answer under intros, detours, or gated assets.

Conversational beats formal.	A helpful-colleague tone is easier to trust and act on.	 Use casual, practical language. Use question-style headings when it fits, then answer directly.  Write like a textbook or overly polished corporate copy.
Clarity beats cleverness.	If someone has to reread a sentence, we've added friction.	 "Create a channel, then map your attributes."  "Give your product data a home base, then let it spread its wings."
Specifics beat superlatives.	Concrete actions and outcomes build credibility.	 "Sync product titles and prices to Shopify automatically."  "Unlock unlimited potential with effortless automation."

Answer first, then expand.	Lead with the concise answer, then add detail for readers who want it.	✓ "Yes. Go to Settings → Attributes → Add Attribute." ✗ "It depends..." (without answering)
Don't say "no." Lead with what we can do.	Keep momentum. Be honest about limits, but make progress the headline.	✓ "You can do Y today using Z, and here's how. (X isn't supported yet.)" ✗ "No, we don't support X."

5. Readability & Writing Tips

Readability Foundation

Foundation	What we aim for	Why it matters
Target reading level	7th–8th grade	More inclusive for non-native English speakers and anyone skimming or reading on mobile. Easier to translate/localize.
Sentence + word length	Short sentences. Short, common words (use vs. utilize).	Faster to scan and understand. Reduces drop-off, especially on small screens.

Word choice	Familiar, conversational language. Define jargon on first use.	Removes friction and builds trust. Keeps complex topics understandable.
Verb tense	Simple past/present/future. Avoid complex/continuous tenses when possible.	Easier to process and localize.

General Writing Tips

Tip	Why it matters	Example
Write for readers and scanners.	Most people skim first. Make key info easy to spot.	 Bullets, short paragraphs, clear subheads  Dense walls of text
Be concise.	Shorter writing is easier to understand and faster to trust.	 "Sync prices to Shopify automatically."  "Unlock effortless optimization for seamless commerce success..."

Demystify on first use.	Jargon adds friction unless you define it immediately.	✓ "A channel is where you send product data (like Shopify or Amazon)." ✗ "Configure your channel mappings to optimize syndication."
Use metaphors carefully.	Metaphors can clarify, but inaccurate ones confuse.	✓ One simple, accurate analogy that matches the concept ✗ A clever metaphor that breaks under scrutiny
Noun precision (the "anti-vague" rule).	Vague pronouns force rereads. Repeat the noun to stay clear.	✓ "Once you create the Attribute, you can assign that Attribute to a Product." ✗ "Once you create it, you can assign it to them."
Quality control.	Important customer-facing content needs native-level polish.	✓ Have a native English speaker review key pages ✗ Publish high-stakes pages without a language check

Rule of three for examples.	Long lists feel overwhelming and are harder to remember.	 "...industries (like furniture, fashion, and sporting goods)."  (Lengthy lists of 10+ industries)
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6. Style & Usage

English & Authorities

- **American English:** Use American spelling (color, specialization, centralized, analyzed).
- [AP Style Guide](#): Our primary guide for style.
- [Merriam-Webster](#): Our authority for spelling.

Punctuation & Symbols

Rule	Example
Punctuation inside Parentheses	Punctuation goes outside parentheses. : At Plytix, we love animals (especially dogs). : At Plytix, we love animals (especially dogs.)
Oxford/Serial Comma	Always use it. : Create, edit, and export custom product lists directly from Plytix. : Create, edit and export custom product lists directly from Plytix.

Punctuation with Quotation Marks	Commas and periods go inside quotation marks. ✓: Our playbook for addressing gray area situations is simple: "Apply common sense and be fair." ✗: ... "be fair".
Contractions	Contractions are encouraged because they fit with our friendly, informal tone. ✓: That's why we've made our technologies... ✗: That is why we have made our technologies...
Ampersands	We avoid ampersands (&), preferring to write out the word "and." ✓: Manage and optimize your product content from one place. ✗: Manage & optimize...

Attributing Quotes

Rule	Examples of good and bad
First and Subsequent Mentions	✓ First: Ronald Chow, Director of Operations. Subsequent: Ronald.

Attribution Verb	✓ "...have more of a support side to it," Ronald said. ✗ ...explained Ronald Chow, Director of Operations.
Short Quotes Placement	✓ "...support side to it," Ronald said.
Longer Quotes Placement	✓ "...Salsify's bells and whistles," Ronald said. "For now, we need a platform..."
Punctuation	✓ "...customer support," Ronald said. ✗ "...customer support." Ronald said. ✗ "...customer support" Ronald said.

Hyphens and Dashes

Rule and Explanation	Examples
Hyphen (-): Use to join words. Primarily for compound words or modifiers.	✓ Compound words: self-restraint
Hyphen (-): Use in numbers. For writing out compound numbers.	✓ Numbers: twenty-one
Hyphen (-): Use in a compound modifier before a noun.	✓ dog-friendly hotel

Hyphen (-): Do not use in a compound modifier after a noun.	✗ the hotel is dog-friendly ✓ the hotel is dog friendly
Em dash (—): Never use in our content. Use a comma, colon, or parenthesis.	✗ The main goal—to increase... ✓ Use a comma: The main goal, to increase conversions, was met.
En dash (–): Never use in our content. Use a hyphen as a replacement for ranges.	✗ pages 1–5 ✓ Use a hyphen: pages 1-5

Lists

Rule	Examples
Complete Sentences	✓ If one of the list items is a complete sentence, use proper punctuation and capitalization on all of the items. ✗ if one of the list items is a complete sentence, use proper punctuation and capitalization on all of the items
Incomplete Sentences	✓ If list items are not complete sentences, don't use punctuation, but do capitalize the first word of each item. ✗ If list items are not complete sentences, don't use punctuation, but do capitalize the first word of each item.

Numbers

Rule	Example
Sentence Start: Always spell out numbers that start a sentence.	 Ten features are included.  10 features are included.
0-10: Spell out zero through ten.	 We found five errors.  We found 5 errors.
11+: Use numerals (11, 42, 105).	 We need 15 participants.  We need fifteen participants.
Currency: Place currency symbols before the number (\$50).	 The cost is \$100**.  The cost is **100\$.
Big Numbers: Write out fully in long-form; abbreviate on social media (1K, 150K).	 We reached one thousand users.  We reached 1K users (in documentation).

Capitalization

Rule	Example

Blog Titles: Use AP Title Case.	 How to Master Product Data Syndication  How to master product data syndication
Headlines & CTA Buttons: Use sentence case (just the first word is capitalized).	 Get started now  Get Started Now
Feature Names: Always capitalize (e.g., Plytix PIM, Brand Portals).	 Plytix PIM  Plytix pim

Bold Text (Scanning & Emphasis)

Rule	Example
Key Terms: Bold the most important part of a sentence to help scanners find the answer quickly.	 To add a new channel, click the Add channel button.  To add a new channel , click the Add channel button.

UI Elements: Bold exact UI labels (e.g., "Click Add channel").	✓ Click Add channel to start. ✗ Click Add channel to start.
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7. Word list

Plytix vocabulary source of truth

- **Brand Portal** (not eCatalog)
- **ecommerce** (lowercase c, no hyphen)
- **omnichannel** (one word, no hyphen)
- **email** (not e-mail)
- **ebook** (lowercase, not Ebook or e-book)
- **website** (not web site)
- **retweet** (lowercase, not re-tweet or reTweet)
- **internet** (lowercase, not Internet)
- **webshop** (one word, not web shop)
- **whiteglove** (one word, no hyphen)
- **white paper** (two words, not whitepaper)
- **Channels** (not Exports or Feeds)

8. Marketing & SEO

Content Strategy Reference

Identify the objective of your content before you start writing:

- **Attention Content:** Spark curiosity and demand. (e.g., "The ROI of PIM.")
- **Exploration Content:** Teach the category. (e.g., "PIM vs DAM.")
- **Plytix Content:** Help people succeed with the tool. (e.g., "Tutorial: Setting up AI in Plytix.")

SEO & AEO Standards (2026)

We write to be the best answer that gets quoted by answer engines (AEO).

Topic/Rule	Example
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TL;DR Blocks	3-5 factual bullets immediately under the H1.
Answer-First H2s	The first 1-2 sentences under every H2 must answer the question directly.
Binary Language	Answer engines struggle with “it depends.” Example: For an integration with Shopify, choose Platform X. For selling only on Amazon, choose Platform Y.
SEO Awareness	Implement SEO elements (ask Jessie Schnaible if unsure).

9. Design Guidelines

Rule	Why it matters	Examples (✓ Good / ✗ Bad)
Filenames	Makes assets searchable, reusable, and helps SEO.	✓ plytix-pim-shopify-connector.png ✗ screenshot_v2_final.png
Contextual relevancy	Reduces cognitive load.	✓ Screenshot sits directly under the step it illustrates. ✗ Screenshot appears 6 sections later.

Alt text required	Common accessibility gap. If it's important enough to include, it needs text.	✓ Alt text added to screenshots, diagrams, and icons. ✗ No alt text on key visuals.
Skip decorative alt text	Screen readers don't need noise.	✓ Background shapes marked decorative / blank alt. ✗ Decorative flourishes described like real content.
Describe purpose	Convey intent. If image doesn't load, alt text should "replace" it.	✓ "Plytix PIM dashboard showing successful sync." ✗ "A screenshot of a computer screen with numbers."
Alt text format	Start with the subject. No fluff like "Image of..."	✓ "Shopify channel run status showing 452 products..." ✗ "Image of a Shopify channel run..."
Be clear and visual	People should be able to picture it.	✓ Specific, concrete descriptions. ✗ Too vague ("dashboard") or overly detailed.

Stay under ~125 chars	Screen readers truncate longer text.	✓ "Plytix Shopify channel status: 452 products synced." ✗ (Long sentences describing every UI element)
Include key text	Otherwise the meaning is lost.	✓ "Error banner: 'SKU is required' on screen." ✗ "Screenshot of an error message."
Describe actions	The action is the point, not the pixels.	✓ "Selecting 'Add channel' in Settings → Channels." ✗ "Cursor on a menu."
SEO/AEO	Use keywords naturally, don't stuff.	✓ "Plytix PIM product attributes mapped to Shopify." ✗ (Keyword-stuffed nonsensical lists)
Buttons/Icons	Describe function.	✓ "Download scorecard" / "Open settings" ✗ "Button" / "Icon"

Capitalization	Start with a capital letter.	 "Plytix PIM dashboard..."  "plytix pim dashboard..."
Color	Mention only if it carries meaning.	 "Green status badge: Synced successfully."  "Blue and green screen with lots of sections."
Captions	Help when explanation is longer.	 Short alt + caption that adds detail.  Stuffing a paragraph into alt text.

Resources

- [Hemingway App](#) (Aim for Grade 7-8)
- [AP Style Guidelines](#)
- [Merriam Webster](#)
- **Support:** hello@plytix.com | plytix.com